BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #48 · VISION AND HEARING LOSS

“I can't enjoy life anymore.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When favorite pastimes like reading, music, conversation, or driving become hard or impossible, we mourn them. Without new sources of joy, life can seem gray.

What Scripture teaches

“You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence.” “The LORD is my strength and my song.” “Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing.” Joy is not tied to one sense. Other senses sharpen, new hobbies appear, and nearness to God and people remain. Grieve what you cannot do, and then look for what you can: audio books, music, touch, taste, conversation, prayer, nature’s sounds or scents.

> *“You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand”* (Psalm 16:11).

Also see

> “The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation” (Psalm 118:14).

> “Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; poor, yet making many rich; having nothing, and yet possessing everything” (2 Corinthians 6:10).

> “When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul” (Psalm 94:19).

> “I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances” (Philippians 4:11).

Common self-statements

- Nothing is enjoyable anymore.
- My favorite things are gone.
- Life is dull.
- I have lost joy.
- There is nothing to look forward to.
- I just exist.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing life is either full or joyless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that joy is gone for good.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling grief and concluding that life is no longer enjoyable.
- Labeling: Calling myself joyless.

Challenging questions

- What did I love that I can no longer do as before?
- What adaptations might return some of it?
- What new sources of joy could I try?

- What moments of joy have I had recently?
- What does Scripture say about joy in God's presence?
- Whom can I enjoy things with?

Truth summary

> Joy is not gone. It may look different. I can grieve what I have lost, try adaptations and new pleasures, and find joy in God's presence and in people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Joy
- Thankful
- Suffering
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't enjoy life anymore"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't enjoy life anymore." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I love that I can no longer do as before?
- ☐ What adaptations might return some of it?
- ☐ What new sources of joy could I try?
- ☐ What moments of joy have I had recently?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about joy in God's presence?
- ☐ Whom can I enjoy things with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord fills me with joy in His presence.
- ☐ He is my strength and my song.
- ☐ I can be sorrowful yet rejoicing.
- ☐ Joy takes new forms.
- ☐ I can try something new.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 16:11
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- ☐ Psalm 118:14
  "The LORD is my strength and my song, and He has become my salvation."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 6:10
  "Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; poor, yet making many rich; having nothing, and yet possessing everything."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] New joys: Each week, note one thing you enjoyed, old or new.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 16:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord fills me with joy in His presence.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Joy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Grieve. Write what you miss.
- [ ] Adapt. Find a way to do an old pleasure differently.
- [ ] Try new. Audio books, music, crafts, or a walk with a friend.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 16:11. Ask for joy.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't enjoy life anymore": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	New joys
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't enjoy life anymore.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, joy has faded. Fill me with joy in Your presence, and show me new things to love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.